such a long tour. In fact, in my view, the reality that we can have a good time together increases, rather than hinders, our chance of success.

Somebody within our own management even went so far as to suggest that the cramp I suffered while batting against the West Indies, and scoring 146 runs, was caused by alcohol; he is clearly unaware I have suffered from cramps during long innings throughout my career, but the baseless rumour duly does the rounds.

Why did we lose so heavily in the semifinal?

In my view, we simply tried too hard. We wanted so badly to overcome South Africa's historic World Cup jinx that we departed from our carefully developed plans and went for the Australians too hard and too soon. We needed to stay calm and to play our normal game.

In a World Cup semifinal, that is much easier said than done.